

Town of Oakville Recommendations: BIA Engagement

From Meeting with Anna Rookyard - February 4, 2026

Official Town Position on BIA Partnership

What Anna Rookyard Said (Special Event Coordinator, Town of Oakville):

"Strongly recommended for organizers to engage with Bronte BIA."

This wasn't a casual suggestion—it was a **strong recommendation** from the Town's Special Event Coordinator.

Why the Town Recommends BIA Partnership

Anna Rookyard's Specific Points:

Geographic alignment makes BIA natural partner

BIA Capabilities:

Strong digital presence and reach

Promotional Platform:

Established channels to amplify event visibility

Business Connections:

BIA has direct relationships with business community

Additional Support:

1. Event Location:

- 1. "Event takes place within Bronte BIA area"
- 1. "Great social media channels and community outreach"
- 1. "Platform for event promotion"
- 1. "Opportunity to engage local businesses"
- 1. "Can provide additional promotional support"
- 1. Resources beyond basic promotion available

What the Town is Already Doing

Town's BIA Coordination:

Courtesy Notification:

- Town will inform BIA that event is happening
- Official communication from Town to BIA
- Establishes legitimacy and Town support for event

Town Marketing Support:

- Visit Oakville event calendar listing (primary Town platform)
- Direct link from Town website to event calendar
- Official Town recognition of event

BIA-Operated Community Resources

Community Notice Boards:

Gazebo Board (Bronte Heritage Waterfront Park):

- Operated by **Bronte BIA** (not Town of Oakville)
- Located at primary event location
- Need to work with Kylie/BIA for posting access

Other BIA Boards:

- Foresters Park board (Kerr Village BIA area)
- Each BIA operates its own community communication boards

Key Insight:

The community boards are **BIA assets**, not Town assets. This makes BIA partnership essential for community-level promotion.

What This Means for BHC 5K

Official Validation:

- Town of Oakville endorses BIA partnership
- BIA involvement is part of Town's recommended approach
- Not optional—it's a strategic priority

Access to Resources:

- Community notice boards controlled by BIA
- Business community connections through BIA
- Social media and promotional channels via BIA

Credibility:

- Town's recommendation gives us credibility with BIA
- BIA knows Town is supportive of event
- Partnership is part of official event planning

Other BIA Recommendations from Town

Consider All Oakville BIAs:

Anna suggested engaging with **all Oakville BIAs** for broader reach:

- **Bronte BIA** (primary—event location)
- **Downtown Oakville BIA**
- **Kerr Village BIA**
- Other Oakville BIAs

Why Multiple BIAs?

- Each has unique promotional opportunities
- Broader reach across Oakville
- Different business communities
- Cross-promotion possibilities

For Feb 19 Meeting: Focus on Bronte BIA as primary partner, but ask Kylie about collaborating with other BIAs.

Timeline Context

When Town Brought This Up:

During Feb 4 Meeting Section on "Marketing and Promotional Support"

The Town's marketing support section included:

1. Visit Oakville event calendar (Town platform)
2. **Bronte BIA partnership (strongly recommended)**
3. Consider other BIA partnerships

BIA partnership was the **second item** in marketing discussion—indicating high priority.

Status of BIA Engagement

What's Already Happened:

- **Jan 28:** Kylie (BIA) reached out proactively to us
- **Jan 28:** Greg sent comprehensive event overview to Kylie
- **Jan 29:** Kylie expressed excitement and requested meeting
- **Feb 2:** Meeting scheduled for Feb 19 at Peach Coffee
- **Feb 4:** Town reinforced BIA partnership recommendation

Kylie's Initial Response:

"I love the vision you and Charles have for the Bronte Harbour Classic 5K - what a fantastic way to bring the community together, celebrate our waterfront, and support local businesses. It sounds like it's going to be an incredible event, and we're excited about the opportunity to collaborate."

Key Talking Points for BIA Meeting

Lead with Town Recommendation:

Opening Message:

"We're here because the Town of Oakville specifically recommended we partner with the Bronte BIA. When we met with Anna Rookyard, the Special Event Coordinator, she strongly emphasized the value of BIA engagement and highlighted your social media channels, community outreach, and ability to connect us with local businesses."

Emphasize Official Support:

Supporting Point:

"The Town is notifying the BIA officially about our event as part of the permitting process. They see BIA partnership as a key component of community events in Bronte."

Highlight Resource Access:

Practical Point:

"We learned that the community notice board at the gazebo—right where our event is happening—is operated by the Bronte BIA, not the Town. That makes partnership essential for community-level promotion."

Complete Town Quote (For Reference)

From Meeting Minutes - Section 14: Marketing and Promotional Support

Bronte BIA (Business Improvement Area):

- **Strongly recommended** for organizers to engage with
- Event takes place within Bronte BIA area
- Town will inform BIA that event is happening (courtesy notification)

BIA Benefits:

- Great social media channels and community outreach
- Platform for event promotion
- Opportunity to engage local businesses
- Can provide additional promotional support

Status:

- Organizers already have meeting scheduled with Bronte BIA for next week
- Will meet with Kylie (BIA representative)

Other BIA Recommendations:

- Consider engaging with all Oakville BIAs for broader reach
- Each BIA may have unique promotional suggestions and opportunities

How to Use This Information in Meeting

1. Establish Credibility Early

"The Town of Oakville strongly recommended we meet with you..."

2. Show You're Following Official Guidance

"We're following the Town's recommended approach for community events..."

3. Demonstrate Understanding of BIA's Value

"Anna specifically mentioned your social media channels and business connections..."

4. Position as Partnership, Not Request

"The Town sees BIA partnership as integral to successful community events in Bronte..."

5. Reference Official Process

"The Town is officially notifying you about our event as part of the permitting..."

Additional Context

Town's Approach to BIA Relationships:

The Town:

- Maintains strong relationships with all BIAs
- Sees BIAs as key community stakeholders
- Recommends BIA engagement for events in BIA areas
- Provides courtesy notifications to relevant BIAs
- Recognizes BIAs as business community representatives

Why This Matters:

BIA partnership isn't just about promotion—it's about:

- ■ Following Town-recommended best practices
- ■ Engaging proper community stakeholders
- ■ Ensuring business community involvement
- ■ Building sustainable community events
- ■ Creating win-win outcomes for all parties

Post-Meeting Follow-Up with Town

After BIA Meeting:

Consider updating Anna Rookyard:

- Brief email confirming BIA meeting occurred
- Share any commitments or outcomes
- Thank Town for the recommendation
- Demonstrate you're following their guidance

Sample Email:

"Hi Anna - Just wanted to update you that we met with Kylie from Bronte BIA as you recommended. The meeting went great and they're committed to supporting the event through [outcomes]. Thank you for the strong recommendation to partner with them—it's been invaluable. Greg"

This shows:

- You listened to Town's guidance
- You're executing on recommendations
- You're keeping Town informed
- You appreciate their support

Document Purpose: Reference material for Feb 19 BIA meeting, highlighting official Town recommendations and endorsement of BIA partnership.

Key Takeaway: BIA partnership isn't optional—it's part of the Town's recommended approach, giving us credibility and establishing the partnership as essential for event success.